Experiment 13
Building Approval-Based Workflow Automation in a Zoho Creator Application

Aim
To build an approval-based workflow in the "Leave Management" application so that every leave request is sent to the manager for approval and the employee is informed about the decision.

Objectives
- To understand what a workflow is and how it is triggered.
- To create an approval process for the leave request.
- To update the status of the request automatically after approval or rejection.
- To send email notifications to the employee and the manager.

Requirements

Item	Details
Software	Zoho Creator account
Application	"Leave Management" application with the Leave Request form and Status field
Users	At least two users: one employee and one manager (the second can be another email id of the same student)

Introduction
A workflow is a set of actions that the application performs automatically when something happens, such as submitting a form. Without a workflow, a manager has to check records manually and inform each employee. In an approval workflow, the request is sent to a person who has the authority to approve or reject it, and the next action depends on that decision.

Flow of the Leave Approval Process

Step	Event	Action by the System
1	Employee submits the leave request	Status is set to "Pending"
2	Request reaches the manager	Approval notification is sent to the manager
3	Manager approves	Status is changed to "Approved" and an email is sent to the employee
4	Manager rejects	Status is changed to "Rejected" and an email with the reason is sent to the employee

Procedure

Part A: Preparing the Form

1. Open the Leave Request form in edit mode.
2. Check that the Status field has the values Pending, Approved and Rejected and that the default value is Pending.
3. Add a "Manager Comments" field of the multi-line type and save the form.

Part B: Creating the Approval Process

1. Go to the workflow or approval section of the application and select the option to create a new approval process for the Leave Request form.
2. Select that the approval should start when a new record is submitted.
3. Choose the manager as the approver.
4. For the "On Approve" action, set the Status field to "Approved".
5. For the "On Reject" action, set the Status field to "Rejected".
6. Save the approval process.

Part C: Adding Email Notifications

1. Add a "Send Mail" action in both the approve and reject actions.
2. Enter the Employee Email field as the recipient.
3. Write a short subject and message, for example "Your leave request has been approved" and include the dates and manager comments.
4. Save the workflow.

Part D: Testing

1. Submit a new leave request as the employee.
2. Log in as the manager and open the pending approval.
3. Approve one request and reject another.
4. Check the Status in the report and check the emails received by the employee.

Observations

Employee	Leave Dates	Manager Decision	Final Status	Email Sent
Anitha	05-Nov to 06-Nov	Approved	Approved	Yes
Karthik	10-Nov to 12-Nov	Rejected - work pending	Rejected	Yes
Divya	16-Nov to 20-Nov	Not yet decided	Pending	No

The email may sometimes reach the spam folder of the receiver, so the spam folder should be checked if the mail is not seen.

Roles Used in the Application

Role	Permissions
Employee	Can submit a leave request and view only own records
Manager	Can view all requests of the team and approve or reject them
Administrator	Can edit the form, workflow and user roles

Common Problems and Solutions

Problem	Possible Reason	Solution
Approval request not received	Wrong approver selected	Check the approver in the approval settings
Status not changing	Field name mismatch in the action	Select the Status field again and save
Email not delivered	Wrong email address or spam filter	Check the Employee Email field and the spam folder

Result

An approval workflow was created for the leave request form. The status of each request was changed automatically according to the manager's decision, and the employee was notified by email.

Conclusion

Approval workflows remove the need for manual follow-up. They make the process faster, keep a clear record of every decision and reduce the chance of requests being forgotten. Zoho Creator allows such automation to be set up easily without writing a separate program.